Statement in support of claim CLM-2026-004817

From: Eleanor Whitcombe

Policy: LRK-TRV-26-0071934

Date: 23 September 2026

To whom it may concern,

I'm writing to explain what happened on our trip to Lisbon from 12 to 19 September. I'm afraid it wasn't the relaxing week we'd planned! I travelled with my partner Tom Ashdown.

Saturday 12 September — lost suitcase

We flew from London Gatwick to Lisbon on Solent Airways flight SA1472. The flight landed a bit late, just after 1pm Lisbon time. Tom's bag came through but mine never appeared on the belt. We went to the Solent baggage desk and they filled in a report and gave me a reference (LISSA41872). They said it was probably still in Gatwick and would come on the next flight.

We got to our hotel (Casa do Miradouro, in Graça) mid-afternoon. I had literally nothing except what I was wearing and my handbag, so that afternoon I went to a pharmacy near the hotel for toiletries — toothbrush, toothpaste, shampoo, deodorant, sun cream and so on — and then to a clothes shop for some underwear, a couple of t-shirts and shorts. On Sunday morning I still didn't have the bag, so I bought a swimsuit and some sandals because we were planning to go to the coast, and a phone charger and plug adaptor, as mine were both in the suitcase.

The suitcase finally arrived at the hotel on Sunday evening. The hotel reception called up to our room to say it had been dropped off by a courier.

I've also included a receipt for a light jacket I bought on the Monday. It was much cooler in the evenings than I'd expected, and all I'd packed was a thin cardigan, so I hope that can be included as part of the baggage claim too.

Tuesday 15 September — phone stolen

On Tuesday we took the train out to Carcavelos beach. In the afternoon, around 3.30pm, we went for a swim together. We stayed close to the shore and our things were on our towels just a short way up the beach. We were in the water for maybe 20 minutes. When we came back to the towels my beach bag had been opened and my phone was gone. Nothing else was taken.

A lifeguard told us where the nearest police station was and we went straight there and reported it. The police were very helpful and gave me a report. I've attached an English translation of it that I did myself using a translation app, as the original is in Portuguese.

The phone was an iPhone 15 (128GB) that I bought in November 2024 for £699. I've attached my receipt. A replacement costs £649 now, which is what I'm claiming.

Wednesday 16 September — ankle injury

On Wednesday we went to Sintra. Walking down the steps from the Moorish Castle path I slipped on some wet stones and went over on my right ankle. It swelled up very quickly and I couldn't put much weight on it. Tom got a taxi to take us to a medical clinic in Sintra, where a doctor examined me and did an X-ray. Luckily nothing was broken — she said it was a sprain and gave me a certificate saying I shouldn't do any prolonged walking for 72 hours. I paid for the clinic with my credit card. I then went to a pharmacy next door for anti-inflammatory gel and an ankle support, and we took a taxi back to Lisbon. I paid the taxis in cash.

I didn't have my GHIC card with me (I left it at home by mistake) so the clinic treated me as a private patient.

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Thursday 17 September — missed boat trip

Back in August, before we went, I'd booked a sunset cruise on the Tagus with Ribeira Boat Tours for Thursday evening as a surprise for Tom. It was €120. Because of my ankle, and the doctor's advice not to walk much, there was no way I could manage the boarding pontoon and the walk along the river, so we didn't go. I emailed the company to ask for a refund or to move it but they said it was non-refundable because we cancelled less than 24 hours before.

We flew home on Saturday 19 September as planned.

I've uploaded all the receipts and documents I have. Please let me know if you need anything else.

Kind regards,

Eleanor Whitcombe